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Technical documentation

Customer Journey Diagnostic Methodology

How the scores, the priorities and the money estimate are produced

- What it measures, and how the stages are weighted
- How an answer becomes a score
- How priorities and the 90-day cycle are chosen
- The money model in full, including every cap
- What the model deliberately does not do

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Why this document exists

Nothing in the report is a matter of opinion

The diagnostic gives people a score, a list of priorities and a figure in pounds. All three are the kind of thing a business owner is right to be sceptical about, because most tools that produce them will not say how.

This document says how. Every threshold, weight, formula and cap used in the report is set out below, along with the reasoning behind it.

The model is deterministic. The same answers always produce the same report. Nothing in the scoring is generated, estimated by a language model, or varied between runs.

8	42	3	0
stages assessed	scored questions	priced leaks	figures invented

Who this is for

Anyone deciding whether to trust the output: a business owner weighing up the report, a partner considering a branded version, or an adviser being handed one of these by a client.

What it measures

Eight stages, weighted by what they are worth

The journey is split into eight stages, each scored on its own. Stages are not weighted equally in the overall score. Two things earn a stage extra weight: how quickly it can be moved, and how much of the loss is recoverable when it is.

Lead Response carries the most weight because it is the fastest-moving number in a service business and the cheapest to fix. Reminders and Retention follow, because a missed appointment and a client who never returns are both losses you have already paid to create.

STAGE	WEIGHT	Q	WHY
Lead Sources & Discovery	**1.0**	6	Important, but slow to move and partly outside your control
Lead Response	**1.3**	5	Fastest to fix, largest recoverable loss, costs nothing but a system
Lead Nurture & Follow-Up	**1.0**	6	High return, but needs sustained effort, not one change
Booking Process	**1.0**	7	Usually a one-off fix with a lasting effect
Confirmation & Pre-Appointment	**1.0**	5	Quietly decides attendance and first impressions
Reminders & No-Show Prevention	**1.25**	5	The cheapest revenue protection available, and widely under-used
Reviews & Reputation	**1.0**	5	Compounding, free, but takes months to build
Retention & Re-engagement	**1.2**	6	Where the profit sits, and the hardest loss to see from inside

Total stage weight: 8.75. Two further questions, asked at the end, collect appointments per week and average appointment value. They are not scored. They exist only to turn the gaps into money.

How an answer becomes a number

Every answer maps to a value from 0 to 1

A question is worth points only if it has a weight above zero and is not free text. Free-text answers are read for context and never scored. Where a question does not apply to how someone works - quoting, for example - the "not applicable" answer scores full marks, so nobody is marked down for a step they do not have.

Single choice

33 QUESTIONS

Each option carries a fixed score set in advance. 1.0 is best practice, 0 is the answer that costs the most. Nothing is scored on a curve against other businesses.

Multiple choice

3 QUESTIONS

The whole selection is scored together, not option by option, because breadth is the point. Three lead sources is not three times one source, and selecting every friction signal is not better than selecting none.

Slider

4 QUESTIONS

A curve converts the number to a score, so the distance between 5% and 10% is not treated as the distance between 45% and 50%.

Rating 1 to 5

3 QUESTIONS

Scored as (rating - 1) ÷ 4, so 1 scores 0 and 5 scores 1.

When someone does not know

Two sliders, no-show rate and enquiry-to-client conversion, carry an honest way out. Not knowing scores 0.3: below any measured answer, above the worst one. Not tracking a number is a real gap, but it is not the same as a bad number, and pretending otherwise would push people into guessing.

Every score is clamped to the range 0 to 1 before it is used, so no single option can distort a stage.

From answers to scores

Two weighted averages, and nothing else

1 The stage score

> stage = total of (answer score × question weight) ÷ total weight × 100

Only answered questions appear on either side of the division. A half-finished section is scored on what was answered rather than penalised for what was not. Question weights run from 0.8 to 1.5 within a stage.

2 The overall score

> overall = total of (stage score × stage weight) ÷ 8.75

The same arithmetic one level up, using the stage weights opposite. Both results are rounded to a whole number once, at the end, rather than at each step.

Stage status

- **Strong** 75 - 100
  Working. Leave it alone and spend the effort elsewhere.
- **Needs work** 50 - 74
  Functioning, but losing people at the edges.
- **Critical gap** 0 - 49
  Actively costing money every week it stays open.

Overall band

Optimised	80 - 100
Functional	60 - 79
Leaking	40 - 59
Critical	0 - 39

The band sets the headline sentence on the cover and the summary page. It does not affect any other part of the report.

How the order is decided

The weakest stage is not always the first one to fix

Priorities are ranked by headroom, not by score. A stage is ranked on how much room it has to improve, multiplied by how much that stage matters.

$$\text{opportunity} = (100 - \text{stage score}) \times \text{stage weight}$$

The three highest become the report's priorities. This is why a stage scoring 46 can outrank one scoring 41: the first hour of work on it buys more.

Quick wins are picked separately: one per stage, weakest stage first, deduplicated, capped at three. One action from each of three stages beats three versions of the same idea, and all three are chosen to be doable in a week without buying anything.

Worked example

From the sample report. The stage with the lowest score is not the top priority.

STAGE	SCORE	WEIGHT	OPPORTUNITY
Lead Response	28	1.3	**94**
Retention & Re-engagement	46	1.2	**65**
Reviews & Reputation	41	1.0	**59**
Reminders & No-Show Prevention	56	1.25	**55**

Reviews scores 41 and Retention 46, yet Retention ranks higher: its weight is greater.

The money model

Three leaks, priced from their own numbers

The estimate uses two numbers the reader gives at the end, appointments in a typical week and what an average one is worth, together with four answers from the assessment: no-show rate, enquiry-to-client conversion, repeat client rate, and what a client is worth over their lifetime.

A year is 50 working weeks, not 52. Annual revenue is appointments per week × 50 × average value, and every figure below is a share of that.

Appointments that don't turn up

bookings × no-show rate × value × 0.5

Half of a no-show rate is treated as winnable, not all of it. Where someone does not track the number, the model assumes 10% and says so on the page.

Enquiries that never became clients

enquiries × 10 percentage points × value per client

Enquiries are worked back from appointments rather than guessed: a client who visits monthly is one enquiry, not twelve. Visits per year come from the lifetime band divided by the appointment value; new clients are what is left after the repeat rate. The lift is capped at 10 points and never takes conversion above 70%. Value per client is half the lifetime midpoint, because lifetime value accrues over years and this is a yearly figure.

Clients who don't come back

bookings × gap to 60% × 0.5 × value

Only half the gap between the current repeat rate and 60% is counted, and the gap itself is capped at 20 points. Nobody closes a retention gap in full.

Restraint by design

Caps, floors and rounding

The caps, and why they are there

18%	35%	£100	£250
of annual revenue is the most any single leak may claim	of annual revenue is the most the total may reach	minimum before a leak is shown at all	minimum total before any money figure is shown

Where a cap bites, the report says so in the line beneath the figure rather than presenting the capped number as a precise one. Figures are rounded to the nearest £100 above £1,000 and the nearest £10 below it, so nothing reads as more exact than it is.

What a client is worth: bands and midpoints

BAND	MIDPOINT USED
Under £250	**£150**
£250 - £500	**£350**
£500 - £1,000	**£700**
£1,000 - £2,500	**£1,600**
£2,500 - £5,000	**£3,500**
Over £5,000	**£7,000**

Each midpoint sits slightly below the middle of its band, and the open top band is read conservatively rather than optimistically. Amounts are read in whatever currency the reader picked. Nothing is converted between currencies.

The 90-day plan

One number, three or four priorities

The plan follows the LEAP structure: a single KPI for the cycle, with every priority chosen because it moves that one number. Spreading effort across eight stages is why most improvement plans stall.

1. **The focus KPI**
   Taken from the stage with the highest opportunity score. Each of the eight stages owns one KPI, so the choice of stage decides the number.

2. **The supporting stages**
   Each KPI declares which stages move it. Those are added weakest first. A supporting stage already scoring 75 or above is skipped, because a priority spent there buys nothing.

3. **The actions**
   The lead stage gets three actions, each supporting stage gets two, drawn from the recommendations that stage's answers generated. Anything already listed as a quick win is left out so the cycle does not repeat this week's work.

4. **The windows**
   Up to four: Weeks 1-2, Weeks 3-6, Weeks 7-10, Weeks 11-13. Fewer where the supporting stages are already strong.

5. **The next cycle**
   Named at the end: the highest remaining opportunity this cycle did not cover, with its own KPI. That is where the following 90 days would start.

What the KPI is worth

Where the lead stage maps to one of the three priced leaks, the cycle carries that figure as what the KPI is worth once it moves. Where it does not, no figure is shown rather than an invented one.

Making it checkable

Every KPI comes with how to measure it

A plan nobody can check is a plan nobody follows. Each of the eight KPIs carries three things: what the number actually is, where to get it, and how often to look.

Sources are deliberately limited to what the reader already has. Inbox and message timestamps, booking system exports, Google Business Profile insights, and a tally kept by hand. Nothing in the report requires buying a tool to measure.

Example: the Lead Response KPI

Enquiry response time

Minutes between an enquiry landing and a useful reply going out.

Where from: The timestamps already in your inbox and your Instagram and Facebook threads. Take the last ten enquiries and write down the gap for each.

How often: Weekly, on a sample of ten. Watch the worst one, not the average.

The report also carries a weekly scoreboard and a rule for what to do when a number has not moved in six weeks: the priority is wrong, not the effort.

Being straight about it

What this model deliberately does not do

It does not benchmark you against other businesses

Scores are measured against defined best practice, not against a peer group. There is no dataset of comparable businesses behind it, so no claim is made about where you sit relative to anyone else.

It does not promise the money back

The figure is what the gaps appear to be costing, estimated conservatively. It is not a forecast of what fixing them will return, and the report does not present it as one.

It does not convert currency

Amounts are read as amounts in the currency the reader picked. There is no exchange rate in the model, because a rate that moves would make the estimate harder to believe rather than easier.

It does not replace your own numbers

Where someone does not track something, the model uses a stated placeholder and flags it. A placeholder is a prompt to start measuring, not a substitute for having measured.

It does not vary between runs

No part of the scoring, prioritisation or money model uses a language model. The same answers produce the same report every time, on any device.

Evidence

Where the research in the report comes from

Four findings are cited on the first page of the report and on the website. Each is a named, dated study with a stated sample. They inform which stages carry extra weight; they are not used to compute any score.

75% decide in under 30 minutes

Consumer Search Behavior, BrightLocal (2026). Survey of 1,200+ US consumers about their most recent local business search.

71% have given up on a booking

Salon and Spa Consumer Survey, Zenoti (2025). Survey of 1,000+ US salon and spa clients.

A third fewer missed appointments

Chong & Jawad, Reducing Did Not Attends at a Community Mental Health Service Through the Implementation of SMS Reminders: A Closed Loop Audit (2025). Missed appointments fell from 7.5% to 5.0%.

97% read reviews first

Local Consumer Review Survey, BrightLocal (2026). Representative panel of 1,002 US adults.

Where a figure could not be verified at its original source, it was left out. Two widely repeated statistics were removed during development for exactly that reason.

Questions about any of this

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